Phone full or battery running out?

Simple fixes you can do yourself, for free. Tick each one off as you go.

Before you delete anything, make sure your photos are backed up (iPhone: iCloud Photos; Android: Google Photos), so nothing is lost for good.

1 See what's filling your phone

☐ Done

Your phone lists what takes up the most room, biggest first.

IPHONE

1. **Settings** > **General** > **iPhone Storage**
2. Wait for the list to load, then look at the top few

ANDROID

1. **Settings** > **Storage** (on Samsung: **Battery and device care** > **Storage**)

2 Clear out big videos

☐ Done

Videos take up far more room than photos, so a few old ones can free a lot of space.

IPHONE

1. Open **Photos** and find **Videos** under **Media Types**
2. Delete the ones you don't need
3. Empty **Recently Deleted** to get the space back

ANDROID

1. Open **Google Photos**, tap your picture
2. Tap **Free up space**. It removes copies that are already backed up

3 Tidy up WhatsApp

☐ Done

Photos and videos people send you in WhatsApp pile up over the years.

1. In WhatsApp, open **Settings** > **Storage and data** > **Manage storage**
2. Tap **Larger than 5 MB** and delete what you don't want to keep

Turn over: making your battery last longer →

4 Turn on battery saving

☐ Done

Makes the battery last longer by turning off things in the background. Turn it on when you're running low.

IPHONE

1. **Settings** > **Battery**
2. Turn on **Low Power Mode**

ANDROID

1. **Settings** > **Battery**
2. Turn on **Battery Saver** (on Samsung: **Power saving**)

5 See what's using the battery

☐ Done

If one app is at the top of the list and you hardly use it, it may be running all the time.

IPHONE

1. **Settings** > **Battery** and scroll down to the list of apps

ANDROID

1. **Settings** > **Battery** > **Battery usage**

An app you don't recognise near the top could be a bad app: see the free lesson "Finding and removing a bad app".

Turn it off and on once a week. A restart clears out things that build up and use the battery.

Turn the brightness down a little. The screen uses more battery than anything else. Swipe down from the top and drag the brightness slider.

Battery still won't last a day? After a few years, batteries wear out. A phone shop can replace the battery, which is often much cheaper than a new phone.